Mohammad Siddique Khan and Shehzad Tanweer, two of the men responsible for the 7/7 attacks, made multiple trips to Pakistan in the years prior and evidence suggested they had connections to Lashkar and Jaish-e-Mohammad. The two men were connected to a wider network in the UK, which included Omar Khyam, the British Pakistani introduced in Chapter 4 who trained with Lashkar in 2000.[188]

Conversations between Mohammad Siddique Khan and Khyam recorded in Britain in early 2004 indicate that the two of them, along with Tanweer, were planning to travel to Pakistan together. During those conversations, they discussed training in the Tribal Areas and waging jihad in Afghanistan. By this point, Khyam had graduated from training with Lashkar to working with an al-Qaeda operative in Pakistan on a plot to explode a fertilizer bomb in the UK and so for him the trip was partly a means of fleeing the country. His arrest thwarted any plan for the three men to travel together, but Siddique Khan and Tanweer went ahead with the trip. When they departed for Pakistan it appears to have been with the intention to wage jihad on an open front—Siddique Khan made a farewell video for his daughter before departing, which suggests he did not expect to return.[189] It is not uncommon for aspiring jihadis to go for training with the hopes of fighting (and dying) on an open front only to be convinced they can do more for the cause by engaging in terrorism back home.

Siddique Khan had already trained in Pakistan and possibly Afghanistan on at least one occasion in the late 1990s or early 2000s, and again in Pakistan in 2003.[190] Tanweer had previous exposure to militants in Pakistan as well, having met members of Jaish-e-Mohammad during a prior trip.[191] Western intelligence officials believe that he, and possibly Siddique Khan too, had also earlier attended Lashkar training sessions focused primarily on indoctrination, which suggests the Daura-e-Suffa, Daura-e-Aama or both.[192] In advance of this final trip, Tanweer reportedly placed an unknown number of phone calls from his home in Britain to Lashkar's compound at Muridke and spent several days there at some point after his arrival.[193] The aforementioned intelligence officials assert he met with members of the senior leadership while at Muridke and believe that both he and Siddique Khan availed themselves of Lashkar safe houses enroute to al-Qaeda's camps in the Tribal Areas.[194]